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Mass. can sue Meta over claims of addiction

Ruling follows recent court losses for internet giants in similar cases

By Hiawatha Bray
GLOBE STAFF

In the latest body blow to the social media industry, Massachusetts’ highest court on Friday ruled that the state can sue technology giant Meta over allegations its popular online sites Facebook and Instagram are too addictive to minors.

The ruling comes in the wake of major courtroom defeats for the industry in other states. Just over two weeks ago, a California jury awarded \$6 million in damages to a 20-year-old woman who said that she’d become addicted as a child to Meta’s Instagram and Google’s social video service YouTube. The day before, a jury in New Mexico issued a \$375 million judgment against Meta for allegedly deceiving users about mental health risks, and concealing evidence that sexual predators use Meta services to exploit children.

The companies have appealed these verdicts, which if they stand, could unleash a torrent of similar lawsuits that could cost the companies billions and lead to a radical overhaul of

SOCIAL MEDIA, Page A5

AI takes scamming to a new level

BETH TEITELL
COMMENTARY

It sounds like the voice-over from a horror movie. But it’s straight from the website of the Department of State. “In today’s digital age,” it reads, “one of the most underestimated threats isn’t found in a computer virus or a sophisticated piece of malware — it’s in the mind.”

The mind.

Oh, yeah, that little thing — that I’m currently going out of.

I was phished recently and the experience transformed me from someone annoyed by two-factor authentication to a person so paranoid that if a website is asking me for my own name, I need to take half a Xanax and run it by a notary.

Some days, I’m afraid to click on links I’ve sent myself.

It was an invite that got me, or an alleged invite, from a woman I admire, for

PHISHING, Page A4

‘Everything that comes in goes out that month. I’m drowning.’

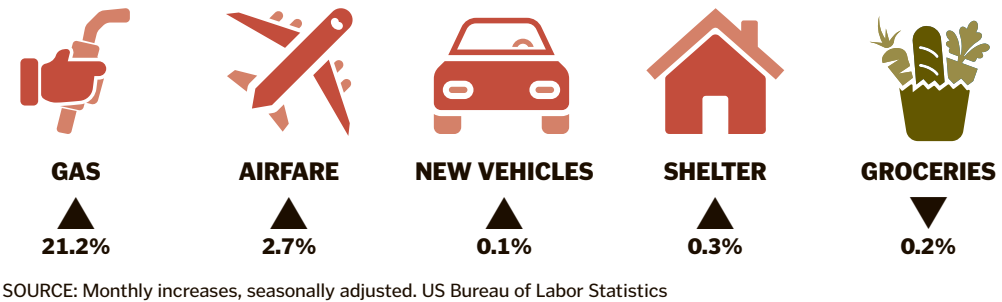
MICHAEL GRAY, semi-retired broadcast journalist based in Westport

Driven down by rising prices



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Angel Gomes filled up his gas tank in Newton, while Buddy rested in the car. Rising fuel prices push up many other costs.



Soaring costs are forcing people to make hard choices

By Omar Mohammed
GLOBE STAFF
and Aayushi Datta
and Lauren Albano
GLOBE CORRESPONDENTS

Soaring gas prices — and inflation in general — are straining the lives of many Massachusetts residents, forcing them to make tough choices on things they might have previously taken for granted, such as visiting a relative, buying a bouquet of flowers for a loved one, or even eating a meal.

The spike has worsened what it’s like to live during the state’s ongoing cost-of-living crisis, especially for those who already live on the margins, some said.

“When you look at the rising prices of food, it’s too high,” said Abigail Fosuaa, a nursing assistant and mother of four from Bedford outside the Market Basket in Chelsea. “The pay rate in Massachusetts has not gone up.”

Rent, utilities, and groceries have all climbed at once, she said. Spending roughly \$4,000 a month in housing costs has left her little room for anything else. Fosuaa makes \$25 an hour, and she has been forced to work more hours to pay the bills.

“I have to overwork myself and work 80 hours or even more before I can put food on

INFLATION, Page A6

You are right. Many everyday things are much more expensive.

By Dana Gerber
GLOBE STAFF

It’s a fact consumers can’t miss any time they go to the supermarket or gas up the car: The war in Iran is reigniting inflation the US spent years trying to tame.

On Friday, the US Bureau of Labor Statistics confirmed the obvious in detail, reporting that consumer prices in March rose 3.3 percent on an annual basis (not seasonally adjusted), the highest rate in about two years and up dramatically from the month before, when prices rose at a 2.4 percent annual clip.

The jump from February was especially large: 0.9 percent (seasonally adjusted), the biggest month-to-month uptick in close to four years.

But the price increases were also somewhat lopsided: Eye-popping surges at the gas

pump, for example, far outstripped the sticker shock most likely felt at the grocery store.

► **Consumer price report shows challenges for Fed, White House. D1.**

Here’s a breakdown of how inflation hit five categories familiar to everyday consumers. (Note: National month-to-month price changes are seasonally adjusted; annual rates are not. All data for the Boston area are not seasonally adjusted.)

Gas

Energy prices were the chief driver of the surge in inflation for March as the war in the Middle East choked off the global supply of oil. For drivers, that meant dramatically

PRICES, Page A6

THEY’RE BACK



NASA VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS

An image provided by NASA showed the Artemis II Orion capsule splashing down in the Pacific Ocean on Friday. The four-person crew completed humanity’s first lunar voyage in more than 50 years. **A7.**

Artemis II makes a splash in his classroom

Boston Latin Academy teacher uses expedition to launch love of science

By Marcela Rodrigues
GLOBE STAFF

Kris Grymonpré was made for this moment.

A science teacher at Boston Latin Academy, Grymonpré was so keyed up by the Artemis II space mission that on Friday he wore a sweat shirt to class emblazoned with an image of the spacecraft used by the four astronauts. And of course, the classroom of a “very geeky science person” would be plastered over with posters and photographs of the solar system.

With the 10-day mission returning to Earth later Friday, Grymonpré told his students the splashdown would be a once in a lifetime experience.

“You’re going to be telling your kids and



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Teacher Kris Grymonpré checked homework in his Boston Latin Academy classroom while wearing an Artemis II sweat shirt.

your grandkids about it,” Grymonpré said.

The lessons started in February, and Grymonpré shared periodic updates about the mission along the way. His eighth grade classes have learned almost every detail about the expedition, from the collection of saliva from the astronauts for scientific experiments to the parachutes that will support the touchdown of Artemis off the coast of San Diego Friday evening.

As the mission comes to an end, the students reflected Friday on what they learned over the past couple of months.

When Grymonpré asked for their favorite moments of Artemis II, Jonas Vasquez recalled when an astronaut was caught live making the infamous Gen Alpha joke “six-

SPACE, Page A7

Vice President JD Vance traveled to Pakistan for peace talks with Iran, even as Israeli strikes against Hezbollah in Lebanon and uncertainty over the Strait of Hormuz raised questions about the durability of the cease-fire. **A3.**

The Trump administration unveiled new renderings for President Trump’s planned 250-foot tri-

umphal arch, his most significant effort to remake Washington’s skyline. **A2.**

Cape Cod Community College has finally given a partial explanation for why former president John Cox was put on paid leave before he abruptly retired earlier this spring. **B1.**



The bright stuff

Saturday: Sunny, breezy. High: 58-63. Low: 39-44.

Sunday: Clouding up. High: 50-55. Low: 44-49.

Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**

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